

5.2.12 WAP

Wireless Access Protocol is designed to enable Internet access from mobile phones. This is done by using a special browser called a WAP browser (Opera Mini, for example), a simplified form of the Desktop browser, and accessing Web sites written in WML (Wireless Markup Language). Though WAP was projected to provide full functionality for Web browsing in phones, the attempt has not been successful because of technical and design issues.

5.2.13 WCDMA

Wideband CDMA is a 3G standard for wireless data access and is designed to provide higher access speeds than the 2G GSM networks. WCDMA is used mostly in Europe and Asia (particularly Japan). It is called wideband because while CDMA transmits on one or more pairs of 1.25 MHz channels, WCDMA transmits data on a pair of 5 MHz channels.

5.3 Mobile Phones

5.3.1 Bands (Dual- / tri- / quad-band)

Mobile networks operate in different frequency ranges in different countries. When a phone is dual-band, it could, for example, work in the 800 MHz / 1900 MHz bands. Such phones are capable of operating in different countries and take advantage of roaming services.

5.3.2 IMEI

The International Mobile Equipment Identity number is a 14-digit number used for identifying GSM handsets. Each handset has its unique IMEI number and has no relation to the SIM. In case of theft, the handset can be banned from accessing the network using the IMEI number, irrespective of whether the SIM card has been changed or not. Various phone models have different key combinations for displaying the IMEI—check your phone manual for your key combination.